

David Gabeau

(240) 593-3853 | davidgabeau92@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/dgabeau | DavidGabeau.com | github.com/primitives-xyz | Brooklyn, NY

PRODUCT LEADER | 0-TO-1 AI PRODUCTS | FOUNDER & CEO

160K users · 59K MAU · 17-min avg session · \$12.5M raised · ex-Snapchat #490

Built an AI-native consumer app and a developer platform from zero, owning product strategy, roadmap, and shipping end to end across a **12-person team** on a **multi-model LLM stack (Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, Minimax)**. Earlier shipped consumer surfaces at **Snapchat (#490, Stories)** to **hundreds of millions of users** and at **Lyft through its IPO**, and invested at Union Square Ventures.

Career Highlights

- ✓ Built Zumi, an AI-native consumer social app, to 160K+ registered users, 59K MAU, 17-minute average daily sessions, and a 4.8 App Store rating within 6 months.
- ✓ Shipped frontier LLM features across companion chat, story generation, voice, and image/video generation, driving **1M+ messages** and **hundreds of thousands of images and videos generated** on a multi-model stack (Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, Minimax).
- ✓ Led model evaluation and routing across the stack, building evals and caching that selected frontier models by workload, cutting AI generation cost ~90% and voice latency 400ms while holding conversation quality.
- ✓ Raised \$12.5M from USV, Redpoint, Slow Ventures, Fabric Ventures, Stellation, and Harlem Capital.
- ✓ Led sprint planning, release coordination, and executive escalation loops for Snapchat Stories during hypergrowth across 200+ shipped features.
- ✓ Sourced **Brilliant** and **Uniswap's Series A** at USV, writing the theses that won partner approval.

CORE SKILLS

Product: 0-to-1 product development, consumer growth, AI/LLM product strategy, evals & model selection, roadmap ownership, A/B experimentation, developer platforms & API design

Leadership: Team building & hiring (12-person team, 5 direct reports), cross-functional leadership, fundraising, GTM

Technical: Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, Minimax · Claude Code, LangChain, LlamaIndex, OpenRouter · Statsig, Metabase, Looker · Supabase, SQL, Python, Node.js · Vercel, Cloudflare · iOS, Android

EXPERIENCE

TAPESTRY (ZUMI) | Brooklyn, NY

Jan 2022-Present

Founder, CEO & Product Lead

Founded Tapestry, an open social-graph API for feeds, follows, and identity, and Zumi, an AI consumer app built on top. **Built and led a 12-person team with 5 direct reports**, all function heads: Product, Design, Engineering, Marketing, and BD. Owned product strategy, roadmap, fundraising, and GTM. Raised \$12.5m from leading VCs.

- **Directed roadmap strategy across a multi-model LLM platform** (Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, Minimax) to balance generation quality, latency, and infrastructure cost, implementing model-routing and evaluation frameworks that **reduced AI generation costs by ~90% while maintaining user experience quality**.
- **Designed and launched multiplayer engagement systems** to address declining interaction patterns common in AI companion products, **driving 244% quarter-over-quarter user growth** and **increasing messages per active user by 40%**.
- Built and scaled a creator-led acquisition program with 10 TikTok partners to improve user acquisition efficiency, **generating millions of views and tens-of-thousands of app installs** while establishing a repeatable growth playbook.
- Grew the developer ecosystem through the Solana Graveyard Hackathon (**74 teams, 96% shipped public repos**) and a 3-week accelerator with a demo day reaching **12.5K live viewers**.

UNION SQUARE VENTURES (USV) | New York, NY

Mar 2020-Dec 2021

Analyst

Sourced and evaluated early-stage AI, consumer, and infrastructure startups on product-market fit and technical architecture for one of NYC's most active venture firms.

- Delivered **2 of the firm's 8 annual investments** from personal pipeline, writing investment theses evaluated against founder strategy, product, and scalability.

LYFT | New York, NY

Aug 2018-Feb 2020

Product Quality Engineer, Rider Experience

Among the first engineers on Lyft's NYC team, through the company's IPO. Sole quality engineer for the rider-collaboration pod, reporting into both engineering and QA leadership and keeping the two orgs aligned on release work.

- Owned release readiness for rider-driver connection features used by **millions of daily riders**, defining release criteria in partnership with Product, Engineering, and Design.
- Drove an **18% reduction in critical bugs** by tightening the release process across teams.

SNAPCHAT | Los Angeles, CA

Dec 2015-Mar 2018

QA Engineer (de facto PM)

Employee #490 (pre-IPO). In Snap's early days, before the company had product managers, filled the de facto PM role for the 30-person Stories pod, coordinating sprint and bug planning across the Stories director, engineering manager, and engineers to keep the team shipping.

- Owned the CEO's escalation path for Stories: product and bug reports from Evan Spiegel came directly to me; I drove each to resolution and reported back to him personally.
- Drove sprint and release planning for **200+ features** across a team of 30 engineers.
- Built the team's automated testing framework (Capybara and Selenium), replacing manual smoke tests each release and cutting hot fixes **80% year-over-year**.

THE HUFFINGTON POST | New York, NY

May 2015-Dec 2015

Software Engineer

Built automated testing systems in Ruby and Selenium for the web platform, improving release speed and reliability.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Bramble (trybramble.ai) | Sole Builder | 2026 – Present Built a local-first macOS app that runs alongside Claude Code and Codex, capturing the full dev event stream into structured, auto-summarized session logs.

AI Atlas NYC (aiatlas.nyc) | Sole Builder | Mar 2026 – Present Built a live market map of NYC's early-stage AI ecosystem, rebuilt nightly by an agent pipeline that scrapes funding and founder signals and re-clusters companies by category; built and host the backend API.

EDUCATION

New York University | New York, NY: Bachelor of Science (BS) Program | Coursework toward B.S.

SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS & PUBLICATIONS

- Solana Accelerate 2025, "Your Social Graph Should Be Yours"
- FarCon NYC, fireside chat with Dan Romero, co-founder of Farcaster, on open protocols vs. platforms
- Solana Boston 2025, "David Gabeau on Tapestry and Social Primitives"
- Bylined article author on USV.com: "Tokenized Natural Assets," "Augmented Reality NFTs," and "Synchronous Entertainment."

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Code Nation | New York, NY: Volunteer Teacher

Sep 2015-Present